Schedule, Spring 2026

NRES 470/670

Please check for updates frequently!

Week	Dates	Topic	Readings	Due	X
Week 1	1/19/2026	NO CLASS: Holiday			
	1/21/2026	LECTURE: Course overview; Intro to Systems Thinking	Gotelli Chapter 1		
	1/23/2026	LAB 1: Introduction to population modeling in Excel, InsightMaker, and R			
Week 2	1/26/2026	LECTURE: Intro to Population Ecology; Exponential growth	Gotelli Chapter 1		
	1/28/2026	LECTURE: Intro to Population Ecology; Exponential growth	Gotelli Chapter 1		
	1/30/2026	LAB 1 (cont'd)			
Week 3	2/2/2026	LECTURE: Malthus and exponential growth	Gotelli Chapter 2		Instructor away
	2/4/2026	LECTURE: Density-dependent population growth	Gotelli Chapter 2		Instructor away
	2/6/2026	LAB 2: Density-dependent populations in InsightMaker; MSY		Lab 1	
Week 4	2/9/2026	LECTURE: Density-dependent population growth	Gotelli Chapter 2		
	2/11/2026	LECTURE: Passenger pigeon/Allee Effect	Gotelli Chapter 2		
	2/13/2026	LAB 3: Age-structured populations in Excel and InsightMaker		Lab 2	
Week 5	2/16/2026	President's Day (no class)			
	2/18/2026	LECTURE: Age-structured populations	Gotelli Chapter 3	Get in project groups	
	2/20/2026	Work in final project groups: PVA proposals			
Week 6	2/23/2026	LECTURE: Age-structured populations	Gotelli Chapter 3		
	2/25/2026	LECTURE: Matrix population models	Gotelli Chapter 3		
	2/27/2026	LAB 4: Matrix population models in R and InsightMaker		Lab 3	
Week 7	3/2/2026	LECTURE: Matrix population models	Gotelli Chapter 3	PVA proposal	
	3/4/2026	LECTURE: Matrix population models	Heppell 1998 (Optional)		

Week	Dates	Topic	Readings	Due	X
	3/6/2026	PVA projects: group meetings (or make alternate arrangements for a group meeting time)			
Week 8	3/9/2026	Review for Midterm #1			
	3/11/2026	MIDTERM #1			
	3/13/2026	LAB 5: Stochasticity and uncertainty		Lab 4	
Week 9	3/16/2026	LECTURE: Stochasticity and uncertainty	Regan 2002 (Optional)		
	3/18/2026	LECTURE: Stochasticity and uncertainty			
	3/20/2026	Work on PVA projects (PVA models due Apr 10)			
Week 10	3/23/2026	Spring Break (no class)			
	3/25/2026	Spring Break (no class)			
	3/27/2026	Spring Break (no class)			
Week 11	3/30/2026	LECTURE: Small population paradigm	Caughley 1994		
	4/1/2026	LECTURE: Declining population paradigm			
	4/3/2026	LAB 6: Metapopulation modeling in InsightMaker		Lab 5	
Week 12	4/6/2026	LECTURE: Metapopulations	Gotelli Chapter 4	PVA models due	
	4/8/2026	LECTURE: Metapopulations	Griffin et al		
	4/10/2026	PVA projects: group meetings (working model and description)			
Week 13	4/13/2026	LECTURE: Source-sink dynamics	Gotelli Chapter 4		
	4/15/2026	LECTURE: Parameter estimation			
	4/17/2026	LAB 7 (optional-no assignment): Parameter estimation: mark-recapture data		Lab 6	
Week 14	4/20/2026	Review for Midterm #2		Complete PVA drafts	
	4/22/2026	MIDTERM #2			
	4/24/2026	LAB: Final Project Peer Review (submit peer review)			
Week 15	4/27/2026	LECTURE: Species interactions: competition	Gotelli Chapter 5		
	4/29/2026	LECTURE: Species interactions: predator-prey	Gotelli Chapter 6		
	5/1/2026	LAB: STUDENT PRESENTATIONS			
Week 16	5/4/2026	LECTURE: STUDENT PRESENTATIONS			
	5/6/2026	NO CLASS: Prep Day			
Week 17	5/11/2026	FINAL EXAM (10:15am to 12:15pm), and extra credit assignments due			
	5/13/2026	FINAL PAPERS DUE			